

PREMIUM SOLVED WORKBOOK

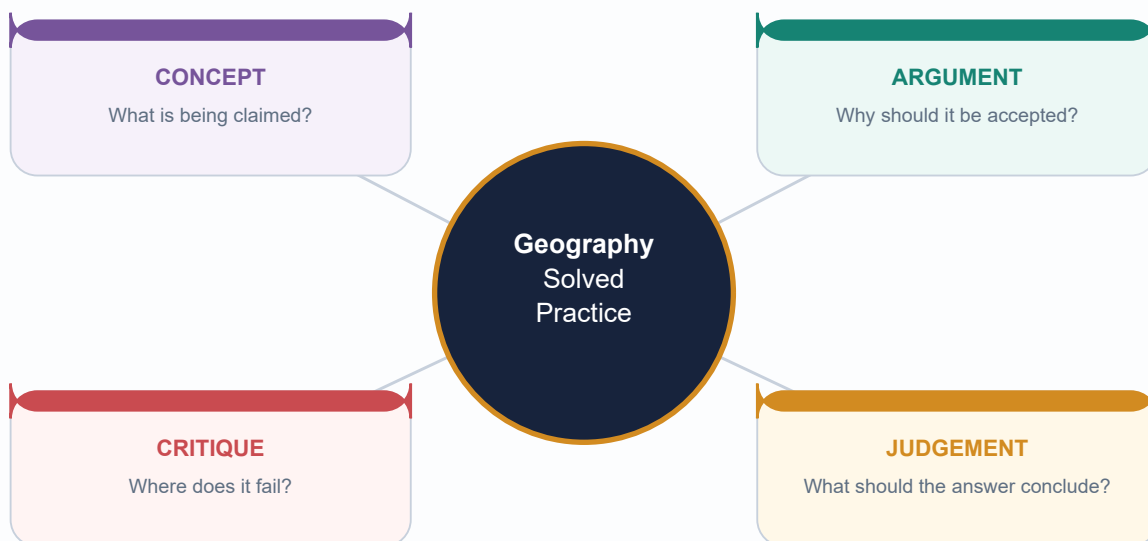
Geography 27 - Solved Practice Workbook

Migration Theories and Patterns in India

Export date and evidence cutoff: 19 August 2026

Verified provenance, strict A-B-C-D rotation and examiner-grade solutions

Status: Generated for review - NOT APPROVED



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

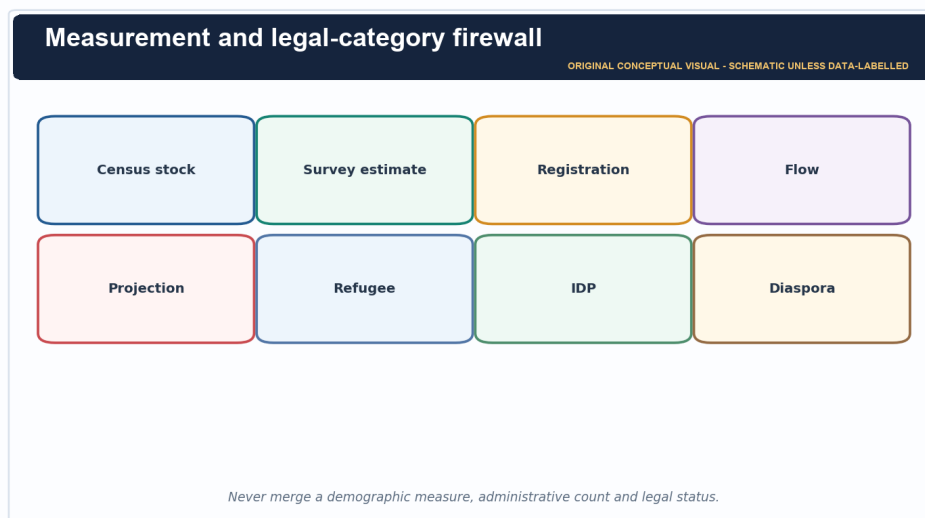
HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

50. PYQ provenance and key protocol

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

PRACTICE VISUAL



Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- Year | Paper | Q | Verified demand | Format | Status

- 2018 | GS-I | 13 | Indentured labour export and diaspora cultural identity | 15 marks, 250 words | Local official scan verified

- 2020 | GS-II | 10 | Indian diaspora in politics and economy of America and Europe | 10 marks, 150 words | Local official scan verified

- 2023 | GS-II | 10 | Economic and political benefits of Indian diaspora in the West | 10 marks, 150 words | Local official scan verified

- 2024 | GS-I | 5 | Why large cities attract more migrants than smaller towns | 10 marks, 150 words | Local official scan verified

- 2024 | GS-I | 19 | Urban migration of skilled young unmarried women | 15 marks, 250 words | Local official scan verified

- 2024 | Prelims GS-I Set A | 75 | Constitutional-list question on inter-State migration/quarantine | Objective | Official Set-A key C locally verified

- The five Mains model answers in sections 51-55 are examiner-grade original solutions, not official UPSC answers. The objective answer in section 56 uses the official local Set-A key. No answer is inferred. If a future local paper lacks an official key, retain the question with INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED, confidence and elimination.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

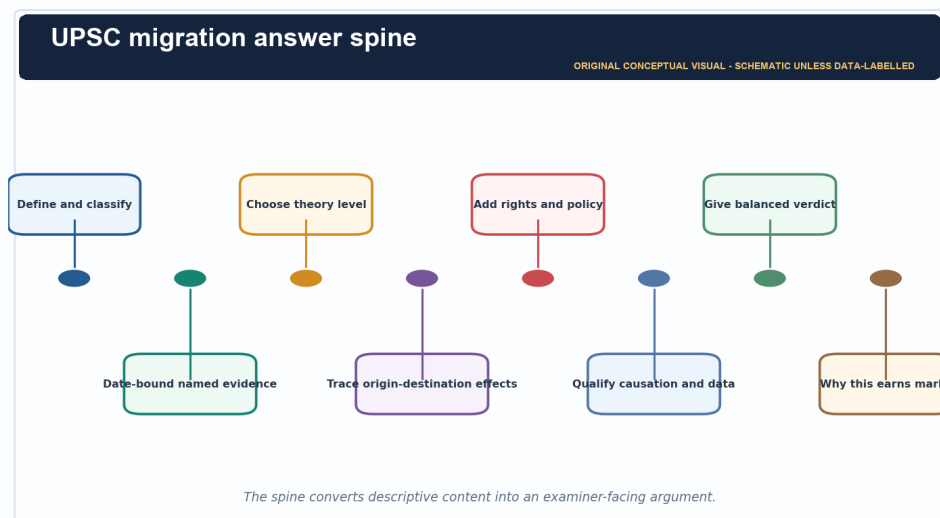
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

51. Workbook solved PYQ - 2024 GS-I Q5

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

PRACTICE VISUAL



Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Why do large cities tend to attract more migrants than smaller towns? Discuss in the light of conditions in developing countries. **10 marks, 150 words.**

- Examiner approach

- Directive: discuss, so explain multiple mechanisms and qualify.

- Core theory: Harris-Todaro + agglomeration + network + Stouffer.

- Essential developing-country feature: diversified informal entry alongside unemployment.

- Must avoid: "better facilities" list.

- Full model solution

- **Claim:** Large cities attract migrants because they combine a broad opportunity portfolio with social networks that reduce entry risk.

- **Named evidence/example:** In Harris-Todaro logic, migrants compare expected urban income—not merely observed wages—with the rural alternative. Metropolises such as Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru and Hyderabad offer construction, transport, retail, domestic work, manufacturing and professional services. Earlier migrants provide job information, initial shelter and credit.

- **Analysis:** Agglomeration raises labour demand, connectivity and access to education, health and finance. The informal sector offers a low-barrier fallback, so migration can persist despite unemployment. Cumulative causation then reinforces established corridors.

- **Qualification:** Large-city rent, unsafe housing and commuting can erode gains. Stouffer's intervening opportunities explains why a dynamic nearer town may intercept movement. Attraction therefore reflects spatial concentration of opportunity, not guaranteed welfare.

- **Verdict:** Build productive intermediate towns and portable urban services rather than restrict mobility.

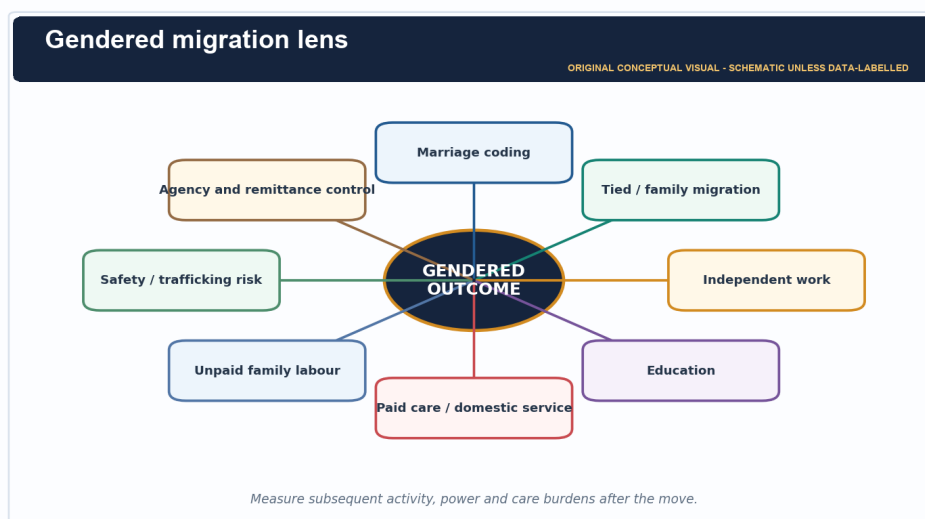
- **Why this earns marks:** It supplies four mechanisms, named theories, Indian examples, a counter-mechanism and a concise spatial-policy conclusion.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**52. Workbook solved PYQ - 2024 GS-I Q19**
GS-I / GS-II
 Geography
PRACTICE VISUAL

Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Globalization has increased urban migration by skilled, young, unmarried women from various classes. How has this trend impacted upon their personal freedom and relationship with family? **15 marks, 250 words.**

- Examiner approach

- Use two balanced columns: freedom and family relations. Add class variation and distinguish capability from mere movement.

- Full model solution

- **Claim:** Urban migration can widen young women's capabilities, yet family power and urban inequality continue across distance.

- **Named evidence/example:** Education and service-sector work in Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Delhi NCR and Mumbai provide independent income, peer networks, occupational identity and greater say over marriage, residence and consumption. Remittances may increase a daughter's bargaining position in the household.

- **Analysis - personal freedom:** Spatial distance from immediate community surveillance can permit new friendships, mobility and career choices. Exposure to diverse workplaces can strengthen legal awareness and confidence.

- **Analysis - family relations:** Digital communication allows frequent contact and care coordination, but can also enable monitoring. Migration may shift relations from direct control toward negotiation. Families may value income while retaining expectations about marriage, remittance and elder care.

- **Qualification:** Class and occupation matter. Secure professionals can purchase safe housing and transport; domestic and informal workers face employer dependence, harassment and weak grievance access. Rental discrimination, unsafe public space and high childcare costs limit substantive freedom. Care work may be redistributed to mothers or sisters rather than disappear.

- **Verdict:** Migration is an enabling condition, not automatic emancipation. Equal work, safe transport, rental access, childcare and responsive institutions are necessary.

- **Why this earns marks:** It directly answers both dimensions, uses city and class examples, recognises digital and care relations, and delivers a graded verdict.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

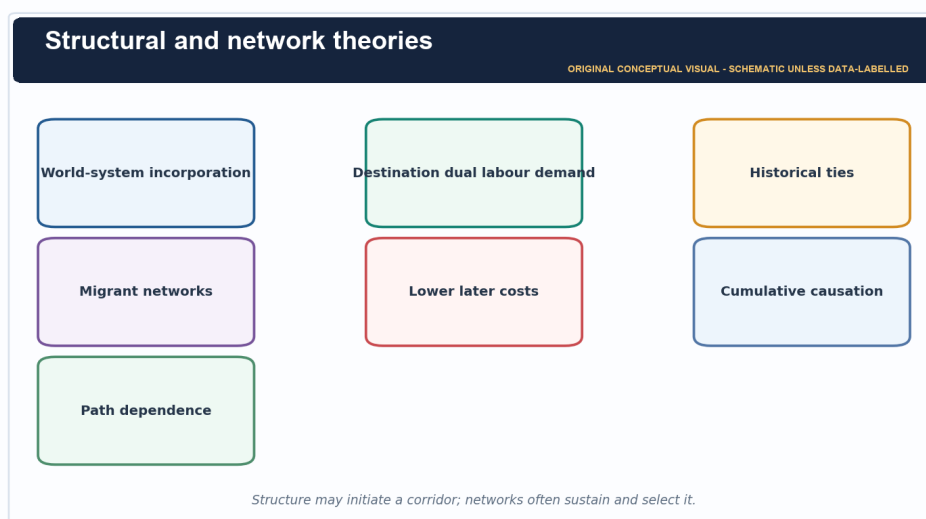
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

53. Workbook solved PYQ - 2018 GS-I Q13

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

PRACTICE VISUAL



Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Why indentured labour was taken by the British from India to other colonies? Have they been able to preserve their cultural identity over there? **15 marks, 250 words.**

- Full model solution

- **Claim:** Indenture supplied controllable plantation labour after emancipation, while Indian cultural identity survived through selective retention and creative adaptation.

- **Named evidence/example:** British colonies in Mauritius, Fiji, the Caribbean and South Africa required labour for sugar and other plantations after slavery's abolition. Colonial poverty, debt, famine exposure and recruiter deception made Indian workers available. Empire-wide shipping, contracts and racial law organised the flow.

- **Analysis:** Employers gained a bounded labour force with restricted bargaining power. Migrants endured long voyages, plantation discipline, family separation and unequal legal status. At destination, they rebuilt social life through Bhojpuri and other languages, Hindu and Muslim practices, festivals, food, music, temples, mosques and associations.

- **Qualification:** Cultural continuity was not pure preservation. Different Indian regions mixed; host societies shaped language and custom; new creole, national and political identities emerged. Some hierarchies persisted, while others changed under demographic and plantation conditions.

- **Verdict:** Indenture was a coercive colonial labour regime, but its descendants retained a recognisable Indian inheritance in transformed diasporic forms.

- **Why this earns marks:** It explains labour demand and recruitment vulnerability, names colonies, answers cultural preservation with evidence, and avoids a static view of identity.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

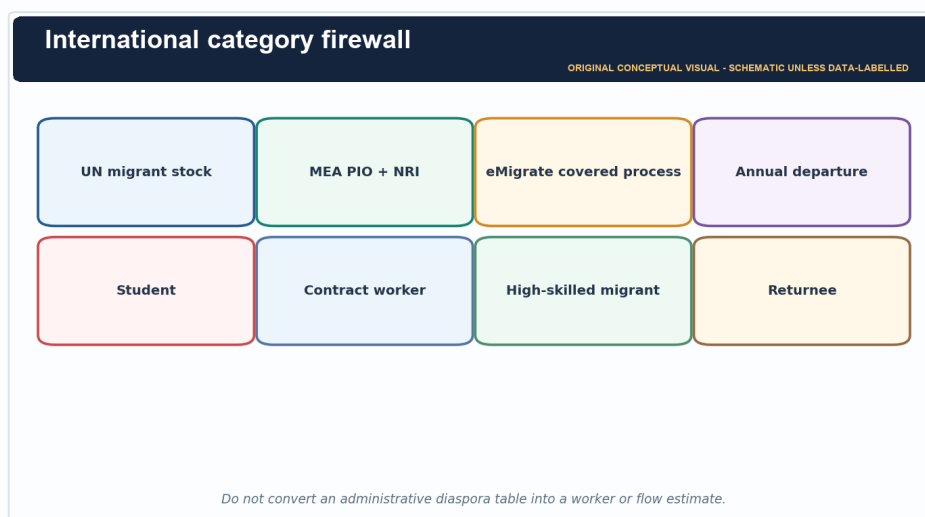
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

54. Workbook solved PYQ - 2020 GS-II Q10

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

PRACTICE VISUAL



Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** "Indian diaspora has a decisive role to play in the politics and economy of America and European Countries". Comment with examples. **10 marks, 150 words.**

- Full model solution

- **Claim:** The diaspora is influential in selected political and economic fields, but "decisive" overstates a diverse community's unified power.

- **Named evidence/example:** Indian-origin professionals and entrepreneurs contribute to technology, medicine, finance, research and universities in the US, UK and Europe. Elected representatives, civic groups and policy professionals can shape debate, philanthropy and bilateral understanding.

- **Analysis:** Diaspora networks lower transaction costs for trade, investment, tourism, research and skilled mobility. Cultural visibility and professional credibility add to India's soft power.

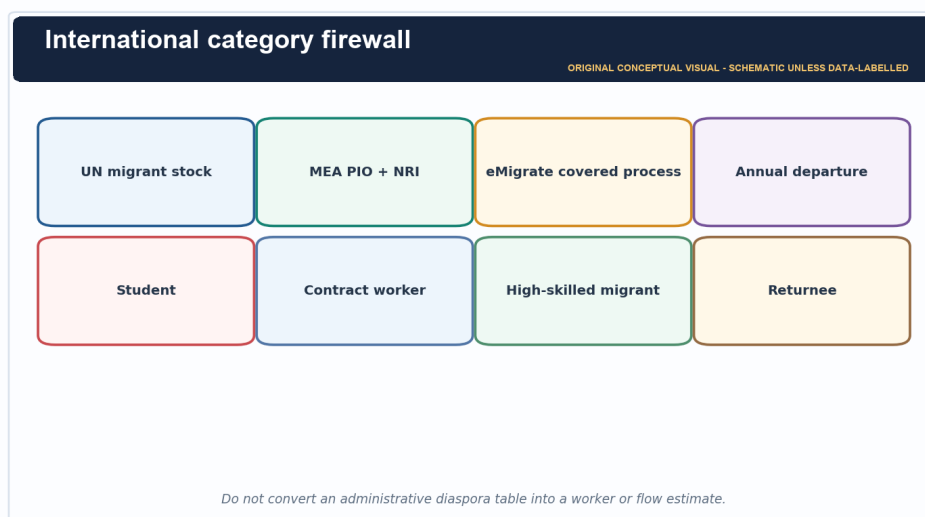
- **Qualification:** Generation, class, religion and political preference differ. Members act primarily within host-country citizenship and interests; they are not a single lobby controlled by India. Low-wage and irregular migrants do not share the same access as elite professionals.
- **Verdict:** Engage the diaspora as an autonomous two-way bridge while prioritising consular welfare, plural representation and knowledge partnerships.
- **Why this earns marks:** It comments on the proposition, gives political and economic mechanisms, names geographies and qualifies “decisive.”

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**55. Workbook solved PYQ - 2023 GS-II Q10****GS-I / GS-II**
Geography**PRACTICE VISUAL**

Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Indian diaspora has scaled new heights in the West. Describe its economic and political benefits for India. **10 marks, 150 words.**
- Full model solution
- **Claim:** Diaspora success benefits India through finance, knowledge, market access, political representation and social networks.
- **Named evidence/example:** Indian-origin communities in North America, the UK, Europe and Australia connect technology firms, universities, hospitals and investors with India. Remittances, philanthropy, tourism and professional associations create material links.
- **Analysis:** Networks reduce information costs, support research collaboration and facilitate talent circulation. Civic and elected representatives can explain India's perspectives and deepen bilateral ties.
- **Qualification:** Benefits coexist with brain drain, unequal mobility, political polarisation and vulnerable contract labour. MEA diaspora totals, UN migrant stock and annual departures are different datasets.

- **Verdict:** India should combine diaspora partnership with safe recruitment, consular protection and pathways for skill and knowledge circulation.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers “describe,” covers both benefit categories, uses named regions and inserts a precise data and vulnerability caveat.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

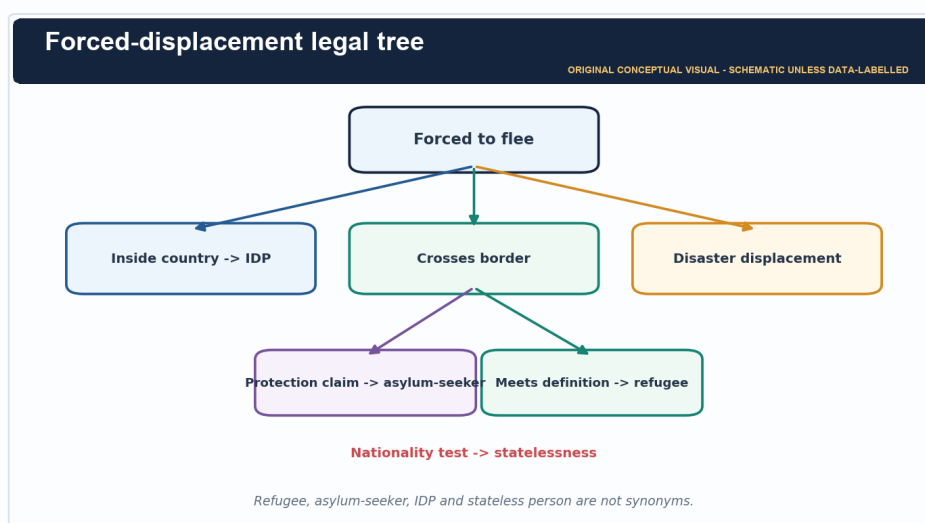
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

56. Workbook solved Prelims PYQ - 2024 Set-A Q75

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

PRACTICE VISUAL



Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Which one of the following statements is correct as per the Constitution of India?

- A. Inter-State trade and commerce is a State subject under the State List.
- B. Inter-State migration is a State subject under the State List.
- C. Inter-State quarantine is a Union subject under the Union List.
- D. Corporation tax is a State subject under the State List.

- **Official Set-A answer: C.**

- **Elimination:** The Union List contains inter-State quarantine. The other statements misplace subjects or taxation powers in the State List.

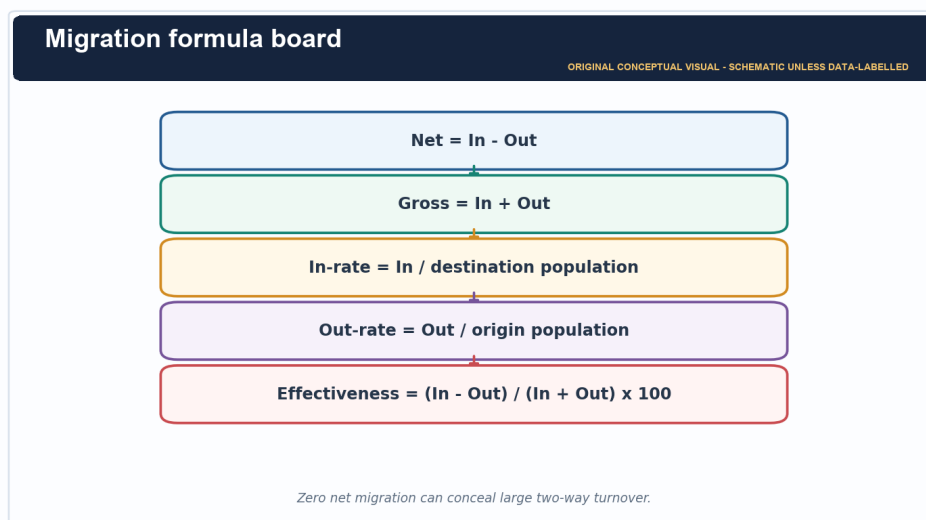
- **Why it belongs here:** Migration governance crosses Geography and Polity, but the question tests constitutional allocation, not migrant stock, motive or rights.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH**57. Hard MCQs 1-8 - vocabulary, measurement and sources**GS-I / GS-II
Geography**PRACTICE VISUAL**

Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- Q1

- Which statement is correct?

- A. Human mobility is broader than migration and can include commuting, tourism and evacuation.
- B. Every commute is a migration flow.
- C. Every evacuation changes usual residence permanently.
- D. Tourism and migration use one universal duration rule.

- **Answer: A.** Mobility is the umbrella concept.

- Q2

- Which measure can be zero even when movement turnover is very high?

- A. Gross migration.
- B. Net migration.
- C. In-migration.
- D. Out-migration.

- **Answer: B.** Equal in- and out-migration produce zero net with high gross movement.

- Q3

- Consider the following statements:

- 1. Place-of-birth data can miss intermediate moves.
- 2. Place-of-last-residence data can miss some circular movement.
- 3. A usual-residence threshold can affect migrant classification.

- How many are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

- **Answer: C.** Each is a standard measurement limitation.

- Q4

- Which is the least defensible inference from mobile-phone mobility data alone?

- A. Relative timing of movement changed.
- B. Some origin-destination intensity can be estimated.
- C. Mobility varies by day or shock.
- D. Every observed device belongs to a legally defined migrant worker receiving welfare.

- **Answer: D.** Device traces do not establish legal category or benefit use.

- Q5

- A destination receives 60,000 migrants and loses 20,000 during a year. Which pair is correct?

- A. Net migration 40,000; gross migration 80,000.
- B. Net migration 80,000; gross migration 40,000.
- C. Net migration 20,000; gross migration 60,000.
- D. Net and gross migration both 40,000.

- **Answer: A.** Net equals in minus out; gross equals in plus out.

- Q6

- Why must a migration rate state its denominator?

- A. Rates are always census counts.
- B. Origin, destination and total-population denominators answer different questions.
- C. Denominators matter only for international migration.
- D. The numerator automatically identifies the denominator.

- **Answer: B.** The population at risk and territorial base must be explicit.

- Q7
- Which source is strongest for small-area all-duration migration stock but weakest for high-frequency circularity?
- A. Ticketing data
- B. Mobile data
- C. Census
- D. Recruiter interviews
- **Answer: C.** Census provides breadth and detail but is infrequent and residence-based.
- Q8
- MoSPI's 2020-21 appendix cautions that its design-based estimated migrant totals:
- A. are annual border flows.
- B. measure every seasonal journey.
- C. replace Census 2011.
- D. are control totals and are not intended as estimates of the number of migrants.
- **Answer: D.** The caution prevents a survey-control total from becoming a headline count.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

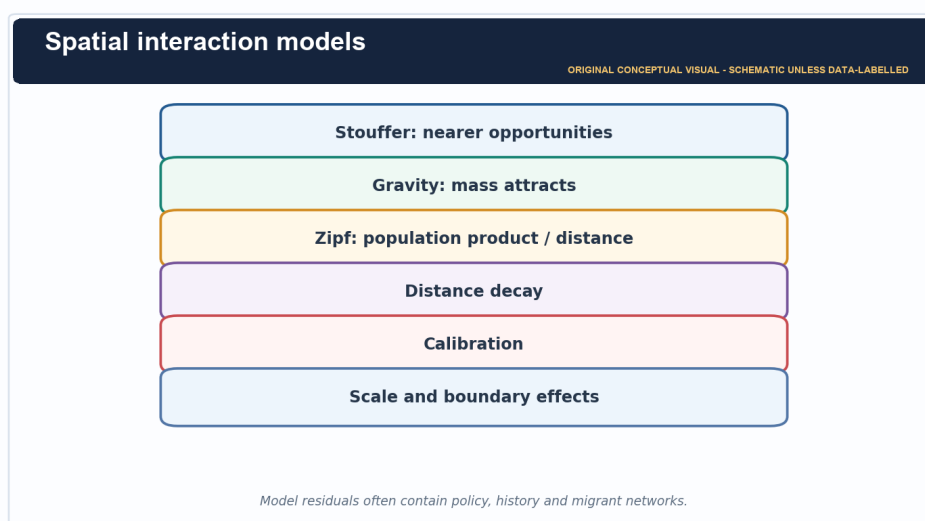
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

58. Hard MCQs 9-16 - migration theories

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

PRACTICE VISUAL



Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- Q9

- Which Ravenstein proposition has the strongest direct relationship with distance decay?

- A. Most movement is relatively short-distance.

- B. Migration has no economic motive.

- C. Every stream lacks a counter-stream.

- D. International borders are irrelevant.

- **Answer: A.** It is a historical empirical proposition, not a universal law.

- Q10

- Lee's framework improves on a simple push-pull list by explicitly adding:

- A. only population size.

- B. intervening obstacles and personal factors.

- C. a fixed migration coefficient.

- D. the abolition of selectivity.

- **Answer: B.** Perception and barriers explain differential response.

- Q11

- In a gravity model, all else equal, increasing distance generally:

- A. increases predicted flow without limit.

- B. has no effect.

- C. reduces predicted interaction according to the calibrated friction parameter.

- D. converts a stock into a flow.

- **Answer: C.** Distance or generalised cost produces friction.

- Q12

- Which is a core limitation of gravity models?

- A. They cannot include any population term.

- B. They always explain personal motives.

- C. They require no calibration.

- D. Aggregate mass and distance can hide policy, networks, discrimination and selectivity.

- **Answer: D.** Residuals require social and institutional explanation.

- Q13

- Stouffer would most directly explain:

- A. a nearer regional city intercepting migrants before a distant metropolis.

- B. why profit reinvestment expands capitalist employment.

- C. why households diversify risk.

- D. the legal definition of a refugee.
- **Answer: A.** Intervening acceptable opportunities matter.
- Q14
- Harris-Todaro predicts migration when:
 - A. the urban formal wage is observed to be high regardless of job probability.
 - B. expected urban return net of cost exceeds the rural alternative.
 - C. every migrant has a guaranteed formal job.
 - D. non-wage motives are the only cause.
- **Answer: B.** Employment probability is central.
- Q15
- The Lewis turning point refers to:
 - A. the end of every form of migration.
 - B. the first urban informal job.
 - C. exhaustion of transferable surplus labour such that broader real wages begin to rise.
 - D. a fall in all capitalist profits to zero.
- **Answer: C.** It is a structural labour-market transition.
- Q16
- Which critique most directly applies to a simple Lewis dualism in India?
 - A. Agriculture has no seasonality.
 - B. Institutions never affect movement.
 - C. Informality is absent.
 - D. Seasonal farm demand, informal urban work, gender and regional variation weaken a clean two-sector split.
- **Answer: D.** The binary model requires institutional and seasonal qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

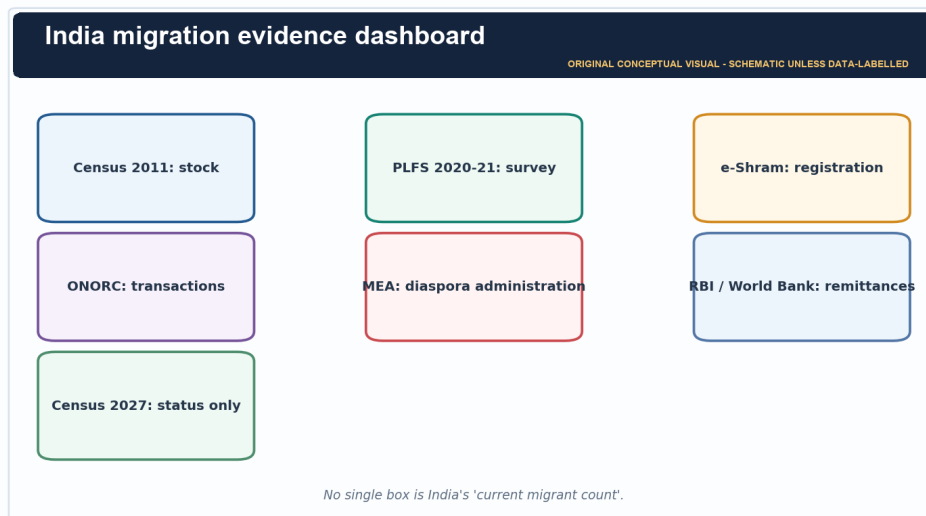
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

59. Hard MCQs 17-24 - households, networks and India patterns

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

PRACTICE VISUAL



Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- Q17

- NELM treats migration primarily as:

- A. a household strategy for risk, credit and income diversification.
- B. a random population event.
- C. a legal status equivalent to asylum.
- D. an outcome with no remittance relationship.

- **Answer: A.** The decision unit shifts toward the household.

- Q18

- Network theory best explains:

- A. the initial global creation of wage inequality by itself.
- B. why a corridor persists after earlier migrants lower later costs.
- C. exact climate attribution.
- D. why no return migration occurs.

- **Answer: B.** Networks reproduce routes more readily than they explain first causes.

- Q19

- Which statement about cumulative causation is correct?

- A. Migration never changes origin conditions.
- B. Every corridor disappears after one cycle.

- C. Migration can alter networks, expectations and labour markets in ways that encourage further movement.
- D. It operates only across international borders.
- **Answer: C.** Movement changes its own future context.
- Q20
- Zelinsky's mobility transition should be used as:
 - A. an exact universal timetable.
 - B. proof that pre-modern societies had no circulation.
 - C. a model independent of demographic transition.
 - D. a historically situated hypothesis linking changing mobility forms with development and urban transition.
- **Answer: D.** It is comparative and non-deterministic.
- Q21
- Which statement correctly describes the PLFS 2020-21 origin distribution?
 - A. 87.5% same State, 11.8% another State and 0.7% other country.
 - B. 87.5% another State.
 - C. 50% international.
 - D. No origin category was collected.
- **Answer: A.** It is a survey distribution, not an annual flow.
- Q22
- In Census 2011 D-03, the largest identifiable settlement-direction stream was:
 - A. urban-rural.
 - B. rural-rural.
 - C. international-urban.
 - D. urban-international.
- **Answer: B.** Marriage and local movement make rural-rural analytically central.
- Q23
- Which interpretation of PLFS's 86.8% female-marriage reason is strongest?
 - A. Women do no economic work after migration.
 - B. The figure is current for 2026.
 - C. It is a dated primary-reason code that can conceal subsequent paid and unpaid work.
 - D. It is a Census 2011 figure.
- **Answer: C.** Instrument, period and coding limit must remain visible.
- Q24

- Which is the safest corridor claim?
- A. Every worker from Bihar goes to Delhi.
- B. Current corridor volumes can be quoted from memory.
- C. State-level routes never change.
- D. Broad eastern/central agrarian origins feed multiple urban-industrial and agricultural destinations, but current rankings require dated data.
- **Answer: D.** It preserves pattern without inventing counts.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

60. Hard MCQs 25-32 - consequences, international mobility and governance

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

PRACTICE VISUAL

Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- Q25
- Which statement best captures remittance effects?
- A. They can reduce poverty and smooth shocks but may also increase inequality or dependency.
- B. They prove productive transformation.
- C. They have no macroeconomic role.
- D. They are always received formally.
- **Answer: A.** Effects depend on channel, control and local opportunity.
- Q26

- Why are MEA Overseas Indians and UN DESA international migrant stock not directly interchangeable?
- A. MEA excludes NRIs.
- B. MEA combines PIO/NRIs in an administrative diaspora compilation, while UN stock uses demographic origin/destination concepts.
- C. UN DESA measures only annual departures.
- D. Both use identical definitions and dates.
- **Answer: B.** The universes differ.
- Q27
- Which statement about RBI and World Bank remittance values is correct?
- A. They must be identical in every year.
- B. RBI measures only rupee cash.
- C. Different reference periods, BoP definitions, revisions and coverage can produce different values.
- D. World Bank data are not date-bound.
- **Answer: C.** Comparison begins with metadata.
- Q28
- Which person is an asylum-seeker?
- A. Every international student.
- B. Every person in a refugee camp.
- C. A person already recognised as stateless.
- D. A person seeking international protection whose claim is pending or intended.
- **Answer: D.** Recognition is not yet final.
- Q29
- Which statement about development-induced displacement is correct?
- A. Acquisition and cash payment do not by themselves prove livelihood rehabilitation.
- B. Common-property loss is always fully priced.
- C. Social networks are irrelevant.
- D. Cultural loss is automatically reversible.
- **Answer: A.** Durable outcome requires post-relocation monitoring.
- Q30
- Which is the correct climate-mobility proposition?
- A. Every climate-exposed person migrates.
- B. Mobility can be adaptation, forced displacement or planned relocation, while some people remain trapped.
- C. "Climate refugee" has a universal treaty definition.

- D. Attribution is always single-cause.
- **Answer: B.** Climate interacts with livelihood and capability.
- Q31
- The latest retrieved e-Shram figure should be used as:
- A. a current interstate-migrant flow.
- B. proof of benefit receipt.
- C. a dated registration stock of unorganised workers.
- D. Census replacement.
- **Answer: C.** Administrative registration is one stage.
- Q32
- Which sequence best evaluates a portability reform?
- A. Announcement → assumed success.
- B. Registration → assumed use.
- C. Eligibility → assumed outcome.
- D. Registration and category accuracy → eligibility → portability availability → successful use → outcome.
- **Answer: D.** Each transition can fail.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

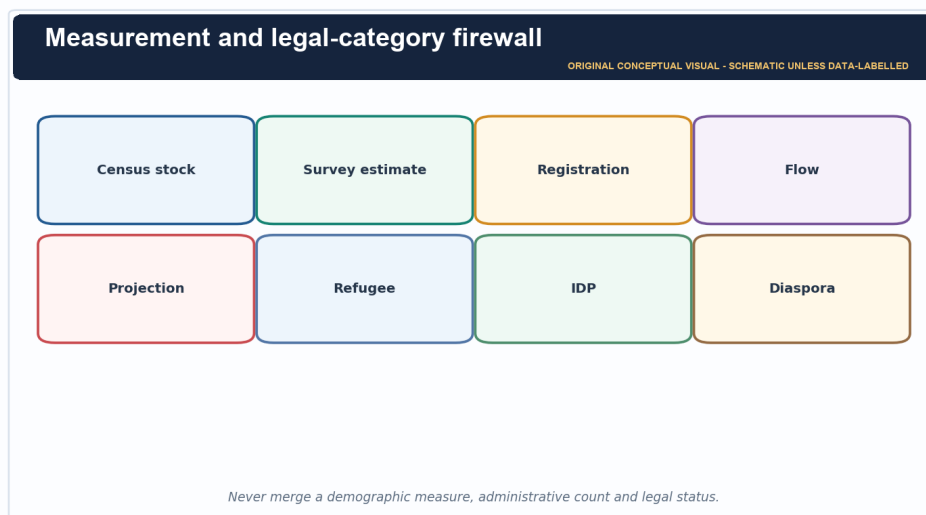
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

61. Remedial MCQs 33-40

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

PRACTICE VISUAL



Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- Q33

- Which is a flow rather than a stock?

- A. Number of entries during April-March.

- B. Migrants resident on Census night.

- C. Registered e-Shram workers at a date.

- D. Refugees present at year-end.

- **Answer: A.** The interval defines a flow.

- Q34

- Why is push-pull insufficient as a full causal theory?

- A. It excludes origins and destinations.

- B. It does not by itself specify weights, household bargaining, labour demand or corridor reproduction.

- C. It mathematically predicts exact flows.

- D. It is a legal definition.

- **Answer: B.** Use it as an organising framework.

- Q35

- Which statement about migration and urbanisation is correct?

- A. Every urban increase is a migrant.

- B. Reclassification is migration.

- C. Natural increase, migration and reclassification must be separated.

- D. Migration never affects peri-urban growth.

- **Answer: C.** Decomposition prevents over-attribution.

- Q36

- Which statement is most accurate?

- A. Every refugee is stateless.

- B. Every IDP crossed an international border.

- C. Every migrant is voluntary.

- D. Refugee, asylum-seeker, IDP and stateless person are distinct categories that may overlap only under specified circumstances.

- **Answer: D.** Legal-category precision is mandatory.

- Q37

- Which is the strongest interpretation of zero net migration?

- A. Inflows equal outflows; gross movement may still be high.

- B. No person moved.
- C. Migrant stock is zero.
- D. Migration effectiveness is always 100%.
- **Answer: A.** Net balance hides turnover.
- Q38
- Which policy most directly addresses circular migrants' multi-local lives?
- A. Restrict inter-State movement.
- B. Portable food, health, schooling and social protection with origin-destination coordination.
- C. Delete origin entitlements.
- D. Treat every worker as permanently settled.
- **Answer: B.** Portability should preserve split-household needs.
- Q39
- Which statement best qualifies "brain drain"?
- A. Every skilled migrant is permanently lost.
- B. Skill movement has no origin cost.
- C. Brain drain can coexist with remittances, return, diaspora networks and brain circulation.
- D. Only low-skilled workers return.
- **Answer: C.** The effect depends on sector, duration and circulation.
- Q40
- Which monitoring choice is least adequate?
- A. Wage and employment by migration type.
- B. Injury and grievance outcomes.
- C. Portability failures and successful use.
- D. One cumulative registration total as proof of complete migrant welfare.
- **Answer: D.** A single administrative stock cannot establish outcomes.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

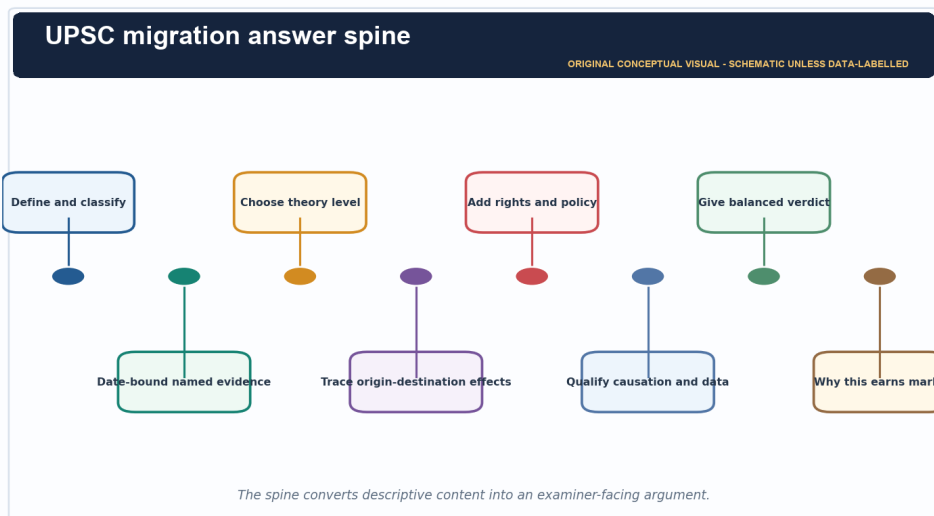
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

62. Original solved practice - theory evaluation, 10 marks

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

PRACTICE VISUAL



Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Compare Lee's push-pull framework with network theory in explaining an established Indian labour corridor. **10 marks, 150 words.**

- Model solution

- **Claim:** Lee explains the perceived origin-destination choice; network theory explains why the choice repeatedly follows one route.

- **Named evidence/example:** Agrarian stress, limited local jobs and higher expected earnings can push and pull workers toward a western industrial or metropolitan destination. Distance, language, fare and documentation are intervening obstacles. Earlier migrants then provide transport information, initial housing, credit and job referrals.

- **Analysis:** Lee clarifies why households facing similar regional inequality respond differently because personal factors and obstacles vary. Network theory explains corridor persistence, occupational clustering and lower costs for later movers.

- **Qualification:** Push-pull does not assign causal weights, while networks explain continuation better than the first move and may reproduce recruiter dependence.

- **Verdict:** Combine Lee with expected-income and structural labour-demand theory for a multi-level account.

- **Why this earns marks:** It compares rather than describes, uses an India-applied corridor and gives a limitation for each theory.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

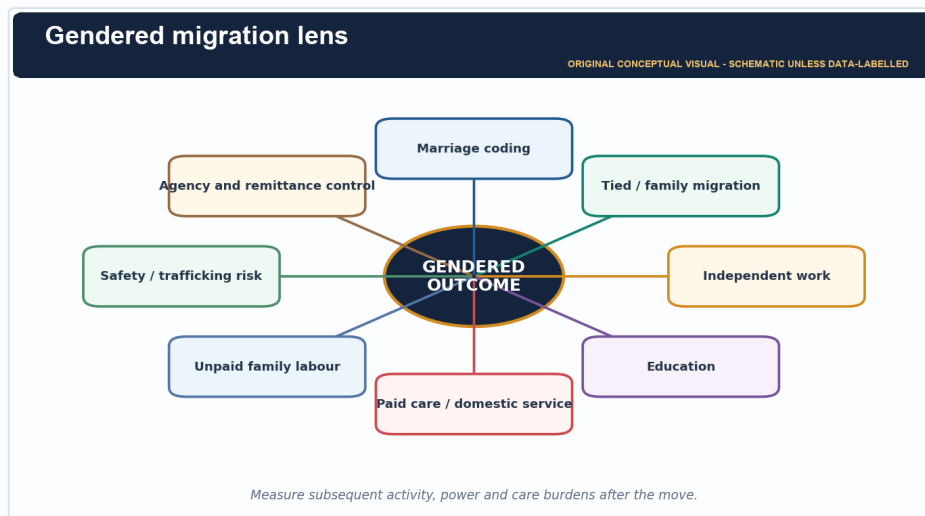
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

63. Original solved practice - gender and data, 15 marks

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

PRACTICE VISUAL



Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** "Reason-for-migration categories can make women's economic contribution statistically invisible." Discuss with reference to India. **15 marks, 250 words.**

- Model solution

- **Claim:** A single primary-reason code can classify the initiating move without measuring a woman's subsequent work, care and household production.

- **Named evidence/example:** PLFS 2020-21 records marriage for 86.8% of female migrants, while Census 2011 D-03 records marriage for about 66.5% under a different all-duration concept. A woman classified by marriage may cultivate land, join domestic service, run a home enterprise or provide unpaid family labour after movement.

- **Analysis:** The category reflects the event that organised relocation, not the full livelihood trajectory. Labour-force surveys may also miss intermittent, home-based or unpaid work. Tied migration can change job access, and safety, childcare, rental location and household bargaining shape later participation.

- **Qualification:** Marriage is a genuine and major social-spatial mechanism and should not be erased. The remedy is not to relabel every marriage migrant as an economic migrant, but to collect multiple motives, subsequent activity, control over earnings and time use.

- **Verdict:** India needs longitudinal and multi-response migration modules linked to labour and care data.

- **Why this earns marks:** It uses two official instruments without merging them, respects marriage as a cause and demonstrates the statistical invisibility mechanism.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

STUDY LINK

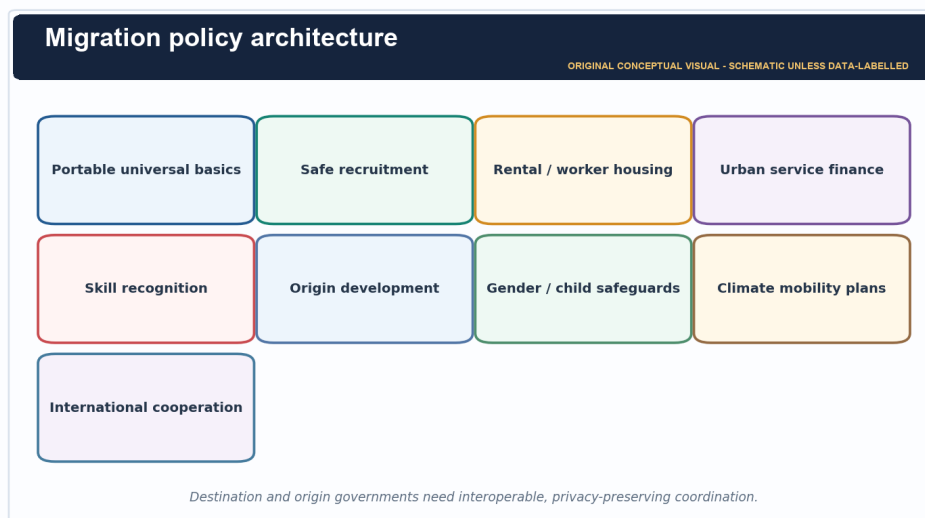
Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

64. Original solved practice - governance, 20 marks

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

PRACTICE VISUAL



Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Design a rights-based migration policy architecture for India and propose indicators to evaluate it. **20 marks, 300 words.**

- Model solution

- **Claim:** Migration policy should enable safe mobility, reduce involuntary distress and make destination planning responsive to mobile residents.

- **Named evidence/example:** e-Shram had over 31.48 crore registrations as on 26 January 2026; ONORC is nationwide; Labour Codes have been effective since 21 November 2025 with expanded inter-State migrant-worker provisions. These create architecture but do not by themselves prove access or outcomes.

- **Policy architecture:**

- 1. portable food, health, school, childcare and social security;
- 2. safe recruitment, written contracts and wage traceability;
- 3. rental housing, hostels, water, sanitation and transport;
- 4. skill recognition and multilingual job matching;
- 5. origin-region climate resilience and intermediate-town employment;
- 6. gender, child, disability and occupational-safety safeguards;
- 7. eMigrate, consular welfare and bilateral social-security cooperation;
- 8. privacy-preserving data interoperability and grievance redress.

- **Indicators:** Measure stock/flow/circularity; wages, hours and informality; rent and crowding; benefit eligibility, successful use and failure; school/health continuity; injury, exploitation and grievance disposal; remittance cost/control; return employment and re-migration; origin-destination inequality.

- **Qualification:** Portability should not delete family entitlements at origin, and mobility data must not become a surveillance or exclusion tool.

- **Verdict:** Evaluate policy by capabilities and durable outcomes, not registrations or announcements.
- **Why this earns marks:** It links current official architecture with a complete policy ladder, measurable indicators, privacy and split-household qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Examiner protocol: identify the directive, build a claim, name evidence, analyse the mechanism, qualify the claim and state why the answer earns marks.

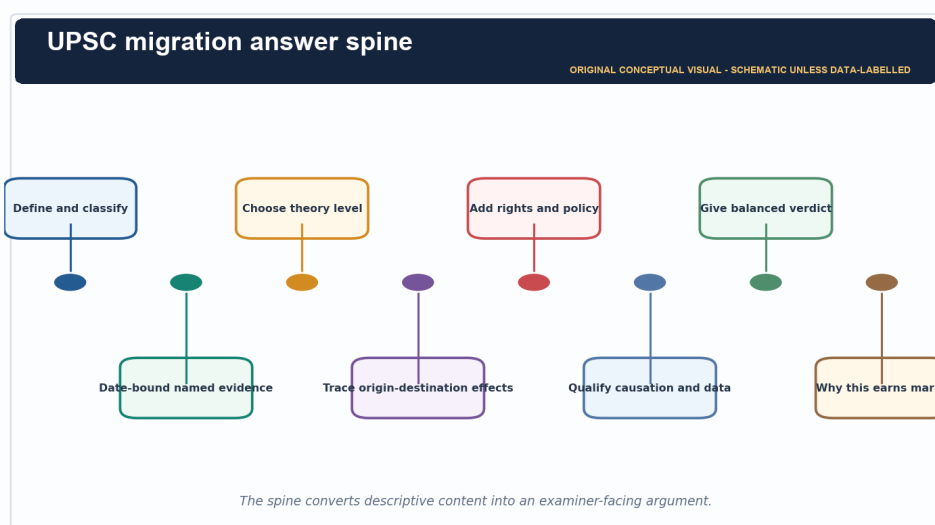
STUDY LINK

Geography → Population, Urbanisation, Regional Development and Economic Geography; Society, Labour, Gender and Social Justice.

HIGH

65. Additional Mains practice prompts with answer spines

GS-I / GS-II
Geography

PRACTICE VISUAL

Use the diagram as a compact answer-planning and elimination aid.

Original conceptual visual reused as an answer-planning aid.

STATIC THEORY

- 10 marks
- **Question:** Why does a gravity model require social and institutional correction when applied to migration?
- **Spine:** Formula and distance decay → calibration → policy/network residuals → gender/class aggregation → verdict that gravity is a baseline, not a complete theory.
- 15 marks
- **Question:** Examine the effects of circular labour migration on source-region agriculture and destination-city productivity.
- **Spine:** Define circularity → remittance and labour-scarcity effects → feminisation/mechanisation/care → destination flexibility/productivity → housing/safety externalisation → portability verdict.
- 20 marks
- **Question:** Distinguish refugee, asylum-seeker, IDP, stateless person and development-displaced person. Why does category precision matter for policy?
- **Spine:** Legal tree → border and nationality tests → protection and data implications → India-context caution → climate-refugee trap → rights-based conclusion.